RESEARCH / 01

Real AI growth does not make every AI asset worth its price

IPO roadshow · Financial anatomy · The AI bubble debate

DeTars Research | November 11, 2026 | Public edition

Demand is real.
Returns are not yet proven.

Our judgment: Anthropic has produced enough evidence to challenge the claims that AI has no real paying demand and that model economics must deteriorate as the business grows. It has not shown that the current IPO price is cheap, let alone underwritten returns across the entire compute-investment cycle.

Formal IPO

Official roadshow launched November 10—not a funding rumor.

$33.242B

9M 2026 recognized revenue—not short-window annualized ARR.

$900.9B

Multiyear commitments—not one year's burn or current debt.

The pivotal shift: The debate should move from “Can AI generate revenue?” to “Who retains the profit, how long before it becomes cash, and how much of that success is already priced into capital today?”

Reading guide: Start with the source materials and financial analysis; then examine the growth, cash and valuation scenarios; finish with the industry cross-checks and verdict. The source register and review boundaries follow at the end. This report provides no trading instructions.

All dollars are USD. B = billions; T = trillions. M = millions for share counts. CFO = cash flow from operations; TTM = trailing twelve months.

[1–3] SEC and original company materials. Other conclusions are this report's inferences.

RESEARCH / 02

This really is a formal IPO roadshow

Identify the material before interpreting the numbers. Marketing is not a completed offering.

Material	Status and timing	How to use it
Official roadshow announcement [1]	Proposed IPO launched on November 10, 2026; $70–78 per share; proposed ticker ANT	Confirms formal marketing—not final pricing or a completed listing
SEC S-1/A-2 [2]	Filed November 10; registration no. 333-299633; financials through September 30	Primary reference for finances and offering structure; 2026 interim data are unaudited
NetRoadshow [3]	Original player: 42:43; financial chapter: 30:09–40:36	The research team obtained the chapter's actual audio and checked key short excerpts using machine transcription
Reuters [4]	August 14 report on the 2028 revenue forecast; November 10 report on the offering valuation	Reliable secondary reporting; an internal forecast is not upgraded into public IPO guidance
Independent publishers, investors and commentary videos [5–8]	Views from different dates and with different interests	Useful for identifying disputes; not independent factual evidence from the same S-1 they cite

Offering structure: gross proceeds, cash to the company and equity value are different things

$74 midpoint; no overallotment	Amount / shares	Qualification
Public offering	825M shares; $61.050B gross	Includes $1.750B sold by existing holders; the company receives none of that portion
Primary shares + concurrent private placements	$59.300B primary gross + $26B private placements	Expected combined net proceeds to the company: $84.6B, still subject to closing
Midpoint equity value	$968.4B basic; approximately $1.333T on a broad diluted bridge	We use the latter; equity value is not enterprise value (EV)

First-hand materials—not an all-purpose “roadshow summary”

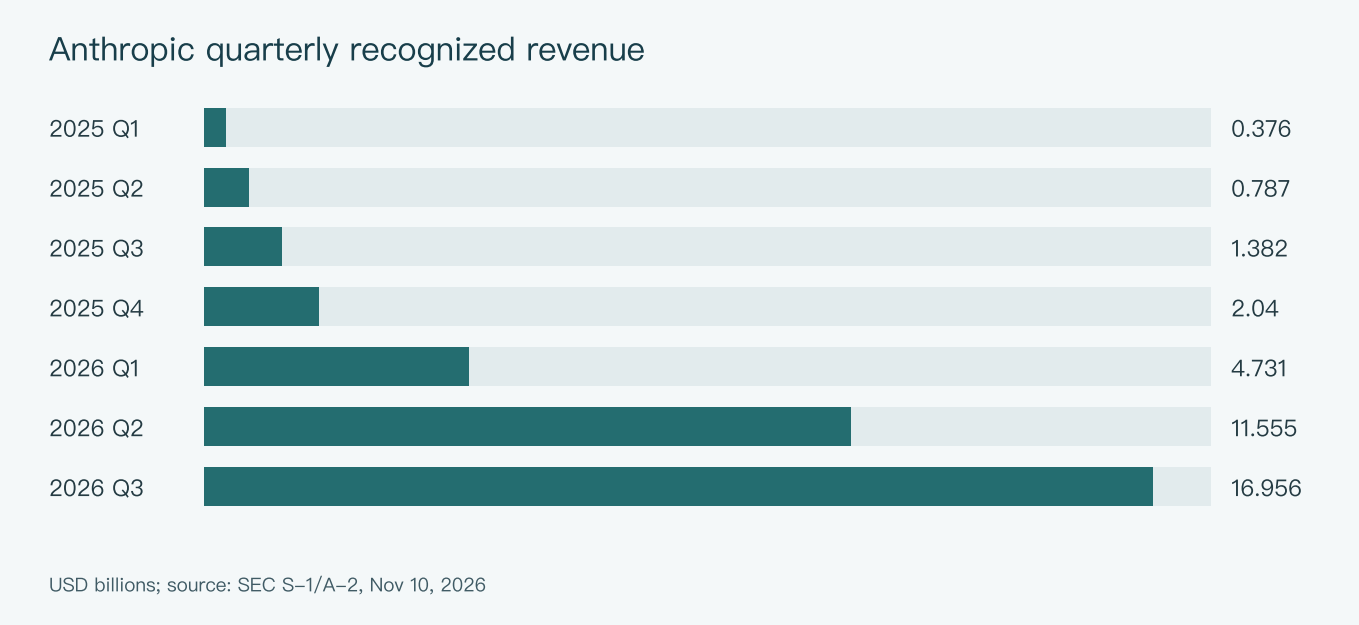
We reconstruct the picture across SEC disclosures, original roadshow audio, media reporting and investor analysis. The 30:35–31:15 video excerpt distinguishes Q3 revenue from year-to-date margins; 39:30–40:15 presents the long-term margin target. These timecodes identify clip boundaries, not sentence-level alignment. We do not claim that the research team manually watched the entire original video.

[1] Full announcement. [2] Cover; pp.19–26, 127; capitalization bridge p.25. [3] Original financial-chapter audio.

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The revenue surge is real, but $81B is not annual revenue

Customer expansion, consumption billing, price cuts and a low base all matter.



Quarter	Revenue (USD B)
2025 Q1	0.376B
2025 Q2	0.787B
2025 Q3	1.382B
2025 Q4	2.04B
2026 Q1	4.731B
2026 Q2	11.555B
2026 Q3	16.956B

[2] MD&A pp.149, 154–157, 164–169; definitions pp.3–4; business p.203; customer and revenue policies F-16/17.

RESEARCH / 03

The revenue surge is real, but $81B is not annual revenue — continued

Customer expansion, consumption billing, price cuts and a low base all matter.

Quarterly GAAP revenue, in USD billions. Q3 2026 revenue rose 46.7% sequentially and was approximately 12.3 times its year-earlier level; first-nine-month revenue rose 1,206% year over year. Slower growth is not declining revenue. [2]

Evidence of real demand

- First-nine-month revenue was $33.242B: approximately 79% consumption-based and 21% subscription-based.
- More than 11,900 organizational customers spent at least $100,000 over the TTM period, contributing approximately 74% of revenue.
- No single customer reached 10% of first-nine-month revenue. Customers outside the top five contributed 79% in Q3: the customer base is broadening.

What cannot simply be extrapolated

- The late-October $81B run-rate equals the preceding 28 days' consumption multiplied by 13, plus that month's subscription revenue multiplied by 12. It is neither contracted ARR nor full-year revenue.
- Approximately 900% net revenue retention (NRR) compares the same quarter's revenue for eligible customers, with a base-period threshold of just $1. It is not a customer-retention rate and cannot be extrapolated as a compound growth rate.
- The company estimates that 5–7% of first-nine-month revenue came from customers subsequently found to have violated its policies. Enforcement will affect subsequent growth.

Our reading: stronger evidence of volume expansion than pricing power

Model price cuts and contractual discounts offset approximately $0.6B of Q3 growth. Enterprise willingness to pay is established. Durable pricing power, mature-customer ROI and subsidy-independent net cash expansion remain to be verified. Purchases financed by AI-company customers' own fundraising do not mean the ultimate industries have already earned back their costs.

[2] MD&A pp.149, 154–157, 164–169; definitions pp.3–4; business p.203; customer and revenue policies F-16/17.

RESEARCH / 04

An 85.5% gross margin can coexist with an operating loss

The key is where recurring frontier research is accounted for—not a claim that gross margin is hidden.

First nine months of 2026; USD B	Earnings bridge	Interpretation
Recognized revenue	33.242	GAAP revenue
Less: customer-service COGS	−4.812	Functional classification in Note 8; primarily customer-serving compute
= Accounting gross profit	28.430 / 85.52%	Recalculated by this report; not profit after all compute costs
Less: research and development	−19.240	Includes model development, research and internal compute
Less: sales and marketing / general and administrative	−6.619 / −3.831	Includes channels, free usage, personnel and donations
= GAAP operating result	−1.260	Not yet cumulatively profitable at the operating level for this period
Add back: stock-based compensation / noncash donations	+3.255 / +2.086	Non-GAAP adjustments; may still dilute shareholders
= Adjusted operating profit	4.081 / 12.28%	Rounded to 12% in the reported presentation

Another yardstick: compute margin

The expense-by-nature presentation reports $18.808B of computing infrastructure expenses across training, R&D, customer service and internal use. 1−18.808/33.242 = **43.42%**. This measures contribution after all expenses in that compute category, not GAAP gross margin. Other expenses must still be deducted to reach operating profit.

Improvement is not one-way

The adjusted operating margin fell from 19% in Q2 to 15% in Q3, while the compute-expense ratio rose from 48% to 58%. Q3 included $5B of expensive short-term compute and $1.960B of noncash donation-matching expense, versus zero for the latter in Q2. The GAAP operating result moved from +$0.974B to −$0.567B; the entire reversal cannot be treated as a deterioration in cash costs.

> **Counterintuitive finding**
>
> Model serving can have excellent marginal economics while remaining competitive at the frontier requires enormous, recurring reinvestment. “Training is a one-time cost that will all become profit later” is not an established fact. Although the primary statement now presents expenses by nature, Note 8 still provides functional COGS. It is wrong to say gross-margin information has disappeared entirely.

[2] MD&A pp.151–157, 161–169; Note 8, Supplemental Operating Expense Information (F-41). All bridges cover the same nine-month period.

RESEARCH / 05

Net loss is not cash burn; positive cash flow is not the end state

Separate valuation remeasurement, operations, investment allocation and financing.

First nine months of 2026; USD B	Amount	Interpretation
GAAP net loss	−104.039	Dominated by noncash remeasurement of financial instruments; not a measure of cash consumption
Add-back: notes / derivatives / SAFE remeasurement	+94.324	Rising valuation remeasures the carrying liabilities associated with earlier financing commitments
Add-back: recognition / remeasurement of other financial instruments	+10.277	Stock compensation, donations and working-capital adjustments also affect the bridge
Cash flow from operations (CFO)	+6.569	A genuine positive signal, but includes collection/payment timing and interest effects
Investing cash flow	−36.546	Includes $33.418B of net short-term securities purchases—not data-center cash burn
Financing cash flow	+110.735	The main source of the cash reserve; it was not all earned by the business

Change the boundary of “free cash flow,” and the number changes

$5.644B

CFO less purchases of fixed assets: 6.569−0.925.

$3.601B

Also deduct 1.955 of leased-equipment prepayments and 0.088 of finance-lease principal.

$131.845B

Cash plus short-term investments at September 30, excluding 2.540 of restricted cash.

The two cash-surplus measures above are **illustrative calculations defined by this report**, not a single company-defined FCF measure. Neither reserves for all future commitments. Stock compensation is not a current-period cash payment, but it is not costless to shareholders. IPO proceeds cannot be treated as received before closing.

> **The cash trap within the growth outlook**
>
> The company explicitly expects Anthropic Direct and its own compute build-out to change the cash-flow profile, with substantial future uses of operating and investing cash. Replacing cloud purchases with chip and data-center leases may improve margins but tie up cash earlier. “FCF is positive this period” does not guarantee that it remains positive during expansion.

[2] Financial statements F-6, F-13/14; MD&A pp.143–144, 176–179. Payables, prepayments, deferrals and receivables also affect CFO.

RESEARCH / 06

$900.9B of commitments: the danger lies in duration, not the headline

Short-cycle consumption revenue meets fixed capacity locked in years ahead.

Commitments bridge; USD B	Amount	Boundary to keep in mind
September 30 fixed long-term schedule	319.993	Purchases 313.819; operating leases 4.224; finance leases 1.950
Short-term agreements	17.4	Outside the long-term schedule above—not nonexistent
Signed leases not yet commenced	451.2	Mostly expected to commence in 2026–2028; average term approximately 10 years
Subsequent long-term / short-term additions	105.7 / 6.6	Signed after September 30; already included in the total
Total	900.9	Multiyear; some final payments extend into 2031–2045
Separately: estimated payments with no fixed dollar amount	150–175	Variable capacity, delivery and pricing conditions; not fixed debt

The near-term cash yardstick

Expected payments in the 12 months after September 30, 2026 are **$70.7B**, including approximately $4.2B subject to conditions or pre-commencement termination rights. This is not “incremental expense” for the next 12 months. Do not add it again to income-statement expenses for the same compute purchases.

The long-term schedule shows minimum payments of $29.165B / $44.357B for 2027 / 2028. It **does not include all uncommenced and subsequent arrangements** and is not the total company-wide commitment for either year.

Asymmetric cancellation rights

Approximately $186.2B of the $900.9B involves pre-commencement termination rights or counterparty financing, data-center and approval conditions. Remedies on the remainder still need to be examined contract by contract. Some delays yield only credits or timing adjustments—not an unconditional right to exit.

Large cash and short-term securities balances and a large proposed capital raise reduce near-term funding pressure. They do not eliminate asset economic-life risk or demand-forecast risk.

> **The core risk mechanism (inference)**
>
> Cloud/chip partners supply capital → model companies lock in capacity → upstream suppliers realize orders and revenue first → if end-customer expansion falls short, model companies bear low-utilization and payment pressure. The same partners act as investors, suppliers, distribution channels and competitors, creating genuine reflexivity. This is not evidence of fabricated revenue.

[2] Contractual Obligations pp.178–180; Infrastructure Service Arrangements; concurrent private placements on the cover. Do not add components to their total again.

RESEARCH / 07

Future revenue could be enormous; forecasts must stay in separate categories

Keep management targets, reported internal forecasts and our scenarios separate.

Material	What it actually says	Treatment in this report
Roadshow management [3]	Long-term adjusted operating margin >35%; compute-expense ratio approximately 45–50%; two other expense categories at 7–10% each	A forward-looking target with no specified attainment year—not a GAAP net margin or cash-flow margin
Reuters, August 14, 2026 [4]	Two people familiar with the matter said the company expected $190–200B of full-year 2028 revenue	A reported internal forecast; we did not obtain the underlying model. Not public IPO guidance issued on November 10
SFA, October 28, 2026 [9]	The author projects an approximately $200B annualized rate at the end of 2027	An author scenario based on quarterly revenue ×4—not full-year 2027 revenue or a company forecast

Our stress scenarios: no false precision for unknowns

All inputs below are our assumptions—not company guidance or market consensus. Fixing Q4 2026 revenue at $24B as a common starting point produces full-year 2026 revenue of $57.242B. A $22–26B Q4 range implies $55.242–59.242B for the year. October's run-rate implies approximately $6.75B of monthly revenue, so the Q4 assumption still requires expansion in the final two months.

USD B; percentages are assumptions	Stressed	Base	Strong execution
2027 / 2028 full-year revenue	90 / 120	135 / 195	180 / 280
2028 computing infrastructure expense ratio	65%	50%	45%
2028 other adjusted expense ratio	25%	23%	18%
2028 total adjusted operating costs	108.0	142.35	176.4
2028 adjusted operating profit / margin	12.0 / 10%	52.65 / 27%	103.6 / 37%

Base-case revenue is anchored to the midpoint of the Reuters range, but **we do not simply assume a 35%+ margin**. Strong execution requires efficiency, Direct and demand to succeed together. Whether non-coding workflows can commercialize as effectively as coding is another critical assumption; a verifiable product-level revenue bridge is currently missing.

> **An honest approach to cash-flow forecasting**
>
> There is no complete annual bridge for future capex, lease commencements, prepayments, taxes and working capital. We therefore cannot mechanically derive FCF from adjusted operating margins. The valuation section independently tests cash-surplus margins of −5% / 5% / 15% / 25%: revenue can keep growing rapidly while concentrated expansion produces negative cash flow. These are input assumptions, not probability forecasts.

[2–4, 9] Costs = revenue × (compute ratio + other adjusted expense ratio); adjusted operating profit = revenue − costs. No GAAP net-income forecast.

RESEARCH / 08

“Only 6.8× 2028 revenue” does not prove the price is cheap

Use a consistent diluted share base; then test cash conversion, discounting and further dilution.

$1.333T

Broad diluted equity value at the $74 midpoint—not EV; final pricing is not assumed.

16.5×

Divided by October's $81B run-rate—not a multiple of recognized revenue for the current year.

6.8×

Divided by assumed 2028 revenue of $195B—undiscounted and still subject to execution risk.

At the same $195B of revenue, cash conversion changes the valuation story

Assumed 2028 cash-surplus margin	Cash surplus (USD B)	Today's equity value / that surplus
−5% (expansion pressure)	−9.75	Not applicable: cash is still flowing out
5%	9.75	136.7×
15%	29.25	45.6×
25%	48.75	27.3×

Cash surplus is an illustrative measure: CFO less cash capital expenditure, leased-equipment prepayments and finance-lease principal. Taxes, working capital and similar items are within CFO. No publicly available itemized cash budget supports these four margins; they show sensitivity only, without deducting distant commitments a second time. These figures are future aggregate corporate cash surplus, do not offset stock-compensation dilution and are not a 2028 per-share shareholder yield.

Reverse the calculation: how much success does today's price require?

$1.333T × 1.15^5 ÷ 30× P/E ÷ 25% net margin

≈ $357.5B of 2031 revenue

Assuming a 15% annualized equity return over five years, a 30× 2031 P/E, a 25% GAAP net margin, no dividends and no further dilution, required 2031 net income is approximately $89.4B. If 2028 revenue is $195B, revenue must still compound at approximately 22.4% annually thereafter. If the share count rises another 20%, approximately $429B of revenue is needed to achieve the same per-share return.

Our valuation judgment

This growth path is not inconceivable. But it requires more than a larger AI market: Anthropic must remain at the frontier, retain profit, avoid deteriorating financing economics and deliver cash. Today's price already buys a great deal of future success. A lower forward sales multiple mainly results from pushing the forecast year further out; it does not reduce risk for free.

[2] Capitalization bridge p.25. [4] Reported 2028 forecast. Multiples and reverse valuation are our calculations—not a strict EV calculation or price target.

RESEARCH / 09

Industry revenue is strong; cash returns on the build-out are weaker

The same quarter, different cash definitions. Group cash flow is not all AI cash flow.

All figures below cover the three months ended September 30, 2026, in USD B. Microsoft's period is FY27 Q1; the others are calendar Q3 2026. Non-GAAP free cash flow follows each company's own definition and **must not be added together indiscriminately**. [10–13]

Company	Revenue signal	CFO	Cash build-out measure	Quarterly surplus
Microsoft	Cloud 63.9, +30%; Azure +48%	58.000	PPE 39.367	18.633
Alphabet	Cloud 30.709, +103%; includes TPU system sales	42.290	PPE 51.355	−9.065
Amazon	AWS 45.984, approximately +39%	42.422	Net PPE 75.878	−33.456
Meta	Advertising 63.061, approximately +26%; not standalone AI revenue	32.786	PPE + lease principal 34.906	−2.120

Microsoft / Alphabet: CFO less cash PPE purchases. Amazon: CFO less (PPE purchases minus proceeds from sales and incentives). Meta also deducts finance-lease principal. Google TTM FCF remains +$19.747B; Amazon's is −$42.357B. Do not compare a quarter with a TTM period.

The strongest bull evidence

AI spending is entering real enterprise budgets, with revenue expanding at both the cloud and model layers. Microsoft says demand still exceeds supply; Anthropic is buying expensive short-term compute to meet demand. The current shortage is not an invented story.

The four companies' 2026 capex outlooks are approximately $170B, $195–205B, $220B and $135–145B, respectively. But Microsoft includes new leases, Amazon's measure is cash-based and Meta includes lease principal. **We do not combine them into a precise total for AI investment.**

The strongest bear evidence

Cash build-out is already outpacing some groups' quarterly operating cash generation. Cloud-segment profit does not include all shared AI R&D. Alphabet's shared-level quarterly loss was $7.655B, primarily including shared AI R&D.

Legacy advertising, office-software and retail profits demonstrate funding capacity—not the ROIC of new AI assets. Negative FCF does not automatically prove a bubble either. Post-build utilization and full-cycle returns still matter.

> **The real question is not “Are GPUs idle today?”**
>
> It is whether today's scarcity rents, utilization and accounting useful lives can persist through the collection period of multiyear contracts. Efficiency gains can simultaneously expand AI usage, lower customer prices and compress rental returns on older compute assets. Stronger adoption and weaker capital returns are not contradictory.

[10–13] Official Q3 2026 earnings materials and calls released October 21/28/29; Microsoft FY27 Q1. The research team read the materials within the stated boundaries and cross-checked Microsoft and Alphabet cash flows.

RESEARCH / 10

AI creates value—but not every layer can retain it

Causal evidence of customer outcomes supports durable demand better than token growth alone.

Real commercial results, not universal magic

In the latest v6 of the randomized retail experiment, search-query optimization lifted sales by approximately **2.9%**, and product descriptions by approximately **2.1%**. The **16.3%** uplift for presales customer service is relative to a control with no live customer service. The sales effect of advertising headlines was negative but not statistically significant. [14]

This supports value in particular tasks—not a proportionate increase in industry-wide profit or macroeconomic productivity. Sales gains on one platform may also include competitive displacement.

Time saved, code produced and profit are not interchangeable

The NBER experiment covered 66 companies and 7,137 knowledge workers. Email time savings were approximately 12% on an intention-to-treat (ITT) basis and 17% as a local average treatment effect (LATE). It did not directly measure overall performance or profit. [15]

METR's 2026 update acknowledges selection bias in the new experiment. Neither the older “19% slower” result nor the new point estimate can establish a general verdict on current tools' productivity effects. [16]

The same end-customer dollar passes through several layers

Business customers: **outcomes and ROI** → applications / workflows: **distribution and accountability** → models: **capability and R&D** → cloud / chips: **capacity and capital**.

This is a schematic, not a market-size estimate. Application revenue, model revenue, cloud revenue and chip sales cannot be summed as end demand; capital goods and services also have different recognition periods. Anthropic recognizes revenue gross through CSP marketplaces and separately expenses channels and compute, making deduplication especially important. [2]

Layer	What is currently visible	Our forward-looking judgment (inference)
Applications / workflows	Some outcome-based evidence; broad, fully loaded ROI evidence is still missing	Those controlling customers, business context and permissions—and accountable for outcomes—are better placed to retain profit
Models	High customer-serving gross margins, alongside enormous recurring frontier R&D	The moat is a combination of capability, product and distribution—not token growth alone
Cloud / chips	Realized revenue and strong upstream capital-goods / distribution rents	Upstream orders do not guarantee downstream ROIC; value may migrate to end customers

[2] Revenue Recognition. [14] arXiv 2510.12049v6 §3.1. [15] NBER w33795, November 2025 revision. [16] METR, February 24, 2026.

RESEARCH / 11

Multiple viewpoints are useful—but must not be counted twice

Preserve interests, dates, errors and original evidence alongside each opinion.

Source	Most useful insight	Limitation to isolate
FourWeekMBA [5]	Contrasts the roadshow's >35% long-term target with Q3's 15%; distinguishes compute contribution from accounting gross margin	Most numbers come from the same SEC filing / company captions; not independent validation of performance
Clouded Judgement [6]	Corrects the treatment of convertible-instrument fair-value losses as cash burn; expects expansion to pressure margins	The author discloses that employer Altimeter invests in Anthropic; based on earlier H1 material. We reject the claim that quarterly figures must be “fully audited”: the SEC interim statements are unaudited
Reddit investor post [7]	Even good products can leave a company bound by fixed compute commitments; highlights cash and contract risk	The author subsequently corrected the post: remeasurement losses cannot be described as transferred compute invoices. Amounts must be updated to the latest S-1
Chinese independent publisher Saibo Chanxin [8]	Collects roadshow access, compute-efficiency discussion and Chinese-language materials; useful for finding leads	The images / 57-page gallery were not read in full; reposted headlines do not establish facts
Bloomberg / Yahoo commentary video [4]	Explains basic versus fully diluted valuation, circular-financing concerns and the meaning of “retail”	The research team read captions from 00:00–03:33, without checking the audio; commentary is not a contract. Suspected transcription errors near the end were excluded
SFA forecast [9]	A clear growth path to a $200B annualized rate at the end of 2027	The author's expectation—not company guidance, and not $200B of full-year 2027 revenue

Three headline-driven misconceptions

- **“A $100B loss means $100B of cash burn.”** This skips financial-instrument remeasurement and the cash-flow bridge.
- **“An 85% gross margin means stable software-like profit.”** This omits recurring R&D, channels and capital tied up in the business.
- **“Only 6.8× 2028 revenue means no bubble.”** This uses unrealized distant revenue to dilute the apparent valuation risk today.

How we weight evidence

Ten articles citing the same S-1 still represent one piece of performance evidence. Different viewpoints help identify mistakes; their number cannot establish truth. We retain the strongest bull and bear interpretations, but adjudicate facts against original materials.

[4–9] Reporting, independent publishers, investor discussion and video. Full identities, dates and reading boundaries are in the source register.

RESEARCH / 12

Verdict: the “no-demand bubble” case weakens; the “returns bubble” case survives

Growth, funding and asset prices face three different tests.

Bubble proposition	Our verdict	Most important reason
AI is all free traffic with no real paying demand	Clearly weakened	Recognized revenue, growth in paying organizations and some causal commercial outcomes are real
Frontier models have no route to better unit economics	Substantially weakened, not settled	Serving margins and compute efficiency have improved; recurring R&D and capital reinvestment remain heavy
Anthropic's current IPO equity price is fair / cheap	Not established; we remain cautious	The diluted price already embeds substantial future success; cash conversion and pricing power need verification
Returns across the entire AI infrastructure cycle are safe	Not supported by present evidence	Multiyear capacity lock-ins, financing reflexivity and capex-versus-CFO tension remain

The four falsification signals we care about most

Observation window	What would support an upgrade	What would prompt a downgrade
2027: mature external customers	Repeat purchases and cash collections expand after credits / vendor financing; fully loaded customer ROI persists	Both usage and net prices fall as subsidies end; mature cohorts contract
2027–2028: capacity delivery	Paid utilization and total cash contribution rise—not just orders	Rental prices / utilization weaken after new equipment comes online, while contractual charges remain rigid
2027–2028: earnings into cash	TTM cash surplus improves after R&D, taxes, prepayments and leases	Strong adjusted profit alongside ever-larger cash tied up in prepayments, equipment and leases
Ongoing: shareholder value	Growth preserves per-share earnings and cash rights	Repeated financing, stock compensation and public-benefit issuance dilute holders; profit fails to become per-share returns

Governance is also a financial condition. Founder Class F retains 50.1% of general voting power, and the Long-Term Benefit Trust (LTBT) can elect a majority of directors. The public-benefit issuance framework may entail further share issuance at stock-price milestones. User value, company scale and common-shareholder returns do not naturally move together. [2]

Our final judgment: We are constructive on AI adoption and the diffusion of capabilities, but cautious on valuations across the chain and the pace of construction. The likelier outcome is not “AI has no value.” It is **a genuine technological revolution in which some capital prices and asset supply run ahead of cash returns**. Bubble risk can coexist with growth; it does not require growth to disappear.

Synthesized from [1–16]. This verdict and falsification framework are our judgments—not company forecasts or statistical probabilities.

SOURCE REGISTER

Sources and review navigation I

Original disclosures first; internal forecasts and market opinions carry lower evidentiary weight.

[1] Anthropic: official roadshow announcement

November 10, 2026; full text, proposed terms and registration not yet effective.

https://www.anthropic.com/news/roadshow-launch

[2] SEC S-1/A-2: core financials, capitalization and contracts

November 10, 2026; cover; selected sections on pp.19–26, 143–169, 176–180 and 203; F-6, F-13/17, F-41 and other excerpts. Not read page by page in its entirety.

https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2130357/000162828026072484/anthropicpbc-sx1ax2.htm

[3] NetRoadshow: original IPO roadshow

Duration 42:43; actual audio of financial chapter 30:09–40:36; three 40/45-second ASR excerpts. No complete verbatim transcript; no manual audio verification.

https://www.netroadshow.com/custom/IPO/Anthropic/retail/roadshow.html

[4a] Reuters / Investing: 2028 revenue forecast

Echo Wang, August 14, 2026; article body. Two people familiar with the matter relay an internal forecast—not public guidance.

https://www.investing.com/news/stock-market-news/exclusiveanthropic-ipo-valuation-hinges-on-190200-billion-2028-revenue-forecast-sources-say-4861650

[4b] Reuters / MarketScreener: proposed IPO valuation

November 10, 2026; article body, approximately $1.4T fully diluted upper-end valuation and offering structure. Only relevant passages are cited; unrelated reporting is not used.

https://www.marketscreener.com/news/anthropic-eyes-1-4-trillion-ipo-valuation-in-test-of-wall-street-s-ai-fervor-ce785edadd8bf32d

[4c] Bloomberg / Yahoo: independent commentary video

November 10, 2026, 17:31 UTC. The research team read the page captions for 00:00–03:33. This relies on page captions; the audio track was not checked.

https://finance.yahoo.com/video/anthropic-targets-1-4-trillion-173111556.html

[5] FourWeekMBA: comparison of the long-term margin framework

Gennaro Cuofano; updated November 11. Article body read; secondary captions and SEC recalculations, not an independent performance audit.

https://fourweekmba.com/ai-anthropics-ipo-video-sees-35-adjusted-margins-q3-was-15/

[6] Clouded Judgement: Dispelling the Myths

October 30, 2026; article body. The author discloses Altimeter's financial interest. We retain the accounting explanation, not the claim that quarterly figures must be fully audited.

https://cloudedjudgement.substack.com/p/clouded-judgement-103026-dispelling

SOURCE REGISTER

Sources and review navigation II

Original disclosures first; internal forecasts and market opinions carry lower evidentiary weight.

[7] Reddit r/stocks: original investor post

October 26, 2026. The research team read the post and the author's correction through the platform, not the comments. Its amounts do not replace the latest SEC disclosure.

https://www.reddit.com/r/stocks/comments/1xg9f2s/i_love_anthropics_products_but_i_think_their_s1/

[8] Saibo Chanxin: Chinese-language IPO materials

November 11, 2026. The research team read the text, not the complete image gallery or embedded video.

https://www.163.com/dy/article/LBF6STNJ0556C3J2.html

[9] SFA Investment Team: The Missing Piece

October 28, 2026; public portion of the article through 19,864 characters, including the Figure 14 definition. The $200B annualized rate at the end of 2027 is the author's scenario.

https://brazilbottomup.substack.com/p/anthropics-s-1-the-missing-piece

[10a] Microsoft FY27 Q1: official earnings release

October 28, 2026; quarter ended September 30. Revenue and cash-flow material through the PPE-purchases line was read; the tail of the release was not.

https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/Investor/earnings/FY-2027-Q1/press-release-webcast

[10b] Microsoft FY27 Q1: official earnings call

Same date. The research team read the CEO/CFO prepared remarks and part of the Q&A, not the full remainder.

https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/Investor/events/fy-2027/earnings-fy-2027-q1

[11a] Alphabet Q3 2026: SEC EX-99.1

October 28, 2026. The research team read the full text and cross-checked segment and cash-flow tables, including shared R&D and the FCF definition.

https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1652044/000165204426000080/googexhibit991q32026.htm

[11b] Alphabet Q3 2026: official earnings call

The research team read the Q3 heading, prepared remarks and part of the Q&A for this event. This event URL can change; confirm the reporting period when reviewing it.

https://abc.xyz/investor/events/event-details/default.aspx

SOURCE REGISTER

Sources and review navigation III

Industry sources, research boundaries and scenario limitations.

[12] Amazon Q3 2026: official earnings release

October 29, 2026. The research team read the full text: three-month and TTM cash flows, AWS and capex.

https://ir.aboutamazon.com/news-release/news-release-details/2026/Amazon-com-Announces-Third-Quarter-Results/

[13] Meta Q3 2026: official earnings release

October 21, 2026. The research team read the full text: PPE, lease principal, legal settlement, advertising and guidance.

https://investor.atmeta.com/investor-news/press-release-details/2026/Meta-Reports-Third-Quarter-2026-Results/

[14] Fang et al.: Generative AI and Sales Productivity

arXiv 2510.12049v6, submitted June 29, 2026; Section 3.1 results cross-checked. Methods and appendices were not read in full; do not extrapolate to macroeconomic total factor productivity (TFP).

https://arxiv.org/html/2510.12049v6

[15] Dillon et al.: NBER w33795

Revised November 2025. The research team read physical PDF pages 1–15, not all appendices. Email-time ITT / LATE effects—not overall profit.

https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w33795/w33795.pdf

[16] METR: 2026 uplift update

February 24, 2026. The research team read the full article body: selection bias and intervals in the new experiment. No single point estimate is adopted.

https://metr.substack.com/p/2026-02-24-uplift-update

Research methods and boundaries

This research draws on public disclosures, audio of the original roadshow's financial chapter, official earnings materials, academic papers and market discussion. The text separates first-party facts, media accounts of internal forecasts and our own scenarios. Reprints of the same prospectus do not count as independent factual evidence. Key calculations were recomputed and received independent content review. Machine-transcribed audio is not a complete verbatim transcript or manual audio verification.

Information as of November 11, 2026. Our scenarios have no probability weights and are neither company guidance nor investment price targets. Evidence remains incomplete on external-customer cash demand net of subsidies, fully loaded customer ROI, returns on new compute assets and a complete forward cash budget. We did not obtain the internal 2028 forecast model, nor separately establish a precise dollar breakdown of training costs. This report is research analysis, not investment advice.